

Chapter 66-5

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When Liang Shi dropped Ling Dang off, she casually bought some fruit.

Nothing expensive, she simply saw a street vendor selling oranges that were bright yellow, and the cherries also looked excellent.

She tasted one and thought they were better than what the supermarket sold, so she bought a bag of oranges and over two hundred yuan worth of cherries.

These things would probably be considered beneath notice by the Liang family.

But for Liang Shi, when going to eat at someone's house, she should always buy something as a gift in return.

And she happened to think these things were delicious, so she bought them back for everyone to try something fresh.

Imported fruits weren't necessarily better than what she bought.

Ling Dang praised the oranges enthusiastically in the car. Xu Qingzhu helped her peel one and shared it with her, even feeding a segment to Liang Shi, who was diligently playing chauffeur.

The orange lived up to its appearance—juicy and sweet.

After getting out of the car, Liang Shi carried two bags of fruit while Xu Qingzhu held Ling Dang's hand.

After returning to the old residence, Ling Dang became much more well-behaved, losing her liveliness from outside, completely transformed into a quiet and gentle little princess.

Everyone in the family was there. Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe had just come out of the study. Qiu Zimin and Father Liang were sitting on the sofa—one scrolling through an iPad reading news, the other flipping through a fashion magazine. Yu Wan and Sun Meirou, the sisters-in-law, were watching a drama on the side.

The family atmosphere was good, looking peaceful and harmonious.

It was Ling Dang who first called out: "Grandpa, Grandma, I'm back."

And so broke the peace.

Liang Xinzhou looked at Liang Shi first: "You're back."

Liang Shi nodded. "Elder Brother, Second Brother."

She stood there, appearing somewhat awkward.

Xu Qingzhu followed her, naturally not faring much better.

"You even bought fruit." Liang Xinhe clicked his tongue. "Our little Liang Shi has grown up."

Liang Shi was familiar with him and glanced at him. "I saw they looked good on the road, so I casually bought some. We can eat them as fruit after the meal."

"Don't bring just anything into the house." Qiu Zimin suddenly said coldly: "This house isn't a garbage dump. Collected garbage decades ago, and still collecting garbage now."

As soon as these words came out, the family atmosphere immediately turned cold.

Ling Dang looked up, confused: "Grandma, what does that mean?"

Qiu Zimin immediately changed her expression, crouching down to explain to Ling Dang: "It means don't pick up dirty, unclean things and bring them back to eat—you'll easily get sick."

Ling Dang frowned. "But no one in our family picks up dirty, unclean things. Everything is very clean."

"Grandma was just speaking casually." Qiu Zimin didn't want Ling Dang to know about these things, so she glossed over this matter vaguely.

But these words could fool a little child, not so many adults present. Everyone could hear the implications in her words.

Liang Shi frowned, wanting to retort, but felt that saying anything in front of so many people would make the atmosphere in this house incredibly awkward and uncomfortable.

Everyone would feel bad, so she held it in.

And Liang Xinzhou said coldly: "This house is quite clean. No one collects garbage."

Then he gestured to a servant standing nearby. "Take this fruit to the kitchen and wash it."

The servant came over and took the fruit away.

Only then did Liang Shi feel a bit better.

But correspondingly, Qiu Zimin frowned, glancing resentfully at Liang Xinzhou.

Liang Xinzhou had no reaction and continued to greet Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu, telling them to come sit down.

Yu Wan and Sun Meirou also stopped watching TV and accompanied Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Wanwan still had one more class at school today, so she would return the latest.

After she came back, the family began their meal.

The seating order was the same as before, but today was Xu Qingzhu's first time eating at the Liang family, so her seat was arranged next to Liang Shi.

At the huge table with dozens of dishes, everyone ate quietly. The villa was so quiet you could hear a pin drop.

No one made a sound.

After finishing the meal, Liang Xinzhou had the servant bring up the prepared fruit.

As soon as he finished instructing the servant, Qiu Zimin frowned and said: "Who knows if things from outside are clean or not? Those plastic bags are all toxic."

"Then you don't have to eat any." Liang Xinzhou said coldly, his glasses covering the sharp light in his eyes, but unable to suppress the cold aura emanating from him. "It's Third Sister's kind gesture. You don't have to be like this, do you?"

"You sure know how to acknowledge sisters." Qiu Zimin let out a light snort. "You don't even know where your real sister is suffering, and you don't even try to find her."

"Ah Zi." Father Liang suddenly spoke. "You just finished eating, say less."

He instructed the servant in a deep voice: "Bring up the fruit Third Miss bought."

The servant was made tense by this family atmosphere and didn't know what to do for a moment.

It was only after Father Liang spoke that she dared go to the kitchen to bring it out.

When the servant brought it up, Qiu Zimin left the dining table with a cold face.

Everyone was made quite unhappy by her.

Liang Shi's gaze swept over everyone present, and she sighed softly with a bitter smile: "I'll go talk to her."

She stood up, then her gaze fell on Father Liang. "Would you like to come along?"

"You two talk." Father Liang said: "I won't participate."

Liang Shi said nothing and got up to go upstairs.

She stood at Qiu Zimin's door and knocked several times. Qiu Zimin opened the door, and upon seeing her, her eyes revealed disgust. Then she said coldly: "What are you doing here? We have nothing to say to each other anyway. You don't acknowledge me as your mother either."

"That depends on whether you acknowledge me as your daughter." Liang Shi said. "I want to talk with you."

She didn't use any respectful terms either.

Someone like Qiu Zimin wasn't really worthy of respect.

Qiu Zimin frowned. "I have nothing to talk about with you. We finished talking last time."

Talking until she was so angry she fainted.